

## GENDER

Swaradhyee vs. Mohnish



## BENDERS

## Design A Blog Using WordPress

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Struggling to find the button that unlocks the theme options, Swaradhyee clicked all the buttons in order. This took some time, but with her fool-proof way of doing things, she eventually found the button. The selection of a suitable theme got her thinking a little too much, we feel. (Go on, girl—just choose one!) At the end, a combination of green and yellow it was. (Flowers and leaves?) Probably because she'd already spent so much time, a harried Swaradhyee skipped the colour and Widget selection entirely. Then she fumbled a couple of times with other sections (Manage, Blogroll, and Options). No widgets and not much customisation, and to top it off, she couldn't figure how to view the blog she'd made!



Mohnish oozed confidence and zest when we told him how simple—and fun—our set task was. He was soon looking at how to choose a theme, but missed the button. He then navigated to a section called *Manage*, but didn't find the theme layout option there either. And then it happened: his cursor jumped to *Presentation*, where all the layout options are. Whew! Zooming through the themes, he selected a distinctive black. Selecting the Widgets was just a matter of some juggling. Content with his efforts, Mohnish selected *View Site*, and sat up grinning at the monitor. OK, it needn't have taken as long as it did, but the layout is a little confusing!

MRAM will likely be used in embedded devices, says Saied Tehrani, Freescale director of MRAM and smartmos technology. The first markets for MRAM are likely to be in settings where durability is critical, such as in automotive and industrial settings.

But then there's the issue of price: a 4-Mbit chip costs \$25, which translates

to \$50 (Rs 2,200) per megabyte! Clearly, it isn't going to replace Flash—or hard disks—in commercial devices anytime soon. Freescale selling MRAM right now is more about potential than profit. The fact is, like we hinted at, that it's been difficult to bring to market. Freescale thinks being the first to sell MRAM will give it an

advantage over rivals such as IBM. "By being first, we know how to leverage the technology, how to advance it into other product portfolios," Tehrani said.

350 MILLION USERS

## The IM Wall Has Fallen

IM interoperability is quite the buzzword right now, but the idea is not new: interoperability between IM services has consistently topped users' wish lists. In October 2005, Microsoft and Yahoo! had announced that with the release of the next versions of their IM products, their users would be able to talk to each other. That announcement, tellingly, followed Google's launch of Google Talk. And now, the walls have been torn down: the latest versions of MSN Messenger (called Windows Live Messenger) and Yahoo! Messenger with Voice can communicate with each other.

There exist third-party software such as Gaim and Trillian, which allow one to connect to more than one IM service at the same time, but the problem is that the IM services don't support such clients—meaning users could experience difficulties when the IM services tweak certain features. In addition, they don't support audio or video chats, which the new Microsoft/Yahoo! network might.

This is a partnered public beta testing of interoperability between the two IM services—meaning the test is to ensure that the

networks can handle the combined 350 million user base, the world's largest. The test service is available in 19 countries, including India. The trial version of the new, interconnected client was out July 13, with the final release expected by the end of this year.

Users will be able to sign up from the services' home pages: messenger.yahoo.com and ideas.live.com. After the testing period, all users across both networks will be able to cross-IM. Voice chat is, however, not on the list of features for the beta.

Delivering a larger, combined user base, says Laura Martin, an analyst at Soleil-Fulcrum Research, should give Yahoo! and Microsoft "more clout in attracting online advertising dollars." She went on to add, "Combining users creates loyalty. Strategically, it becomes best to partner with a competitor," Martin said.

It looks like partnerships and joint ventures are being increasingly resorted to by Internet tech companies: "The enemy of my enemy is now my friend," said Michael Gartenberg, vice president and research director at Jupiter Research ([www.jupiterresearch.com](http://www.jupiterresearch.com)). "With new services coming to market, such as Skype and Google Talk, the ability to maintain interoperability is another reason to remain open and form these types of partnerships."

Joe Wilcox, senior analyst at Jupiter Research, said the new relationship would open the door for cross-advertising. And, "If they're thinking about their future, the integration is just the first step to other things."

## Reverse Hyper Threading...

...is what people are saying AMD is into right now. The company is reportedly working—or has already worked—on a new hardware threading implementation, the so-called Reverse HT. This is AMD's reply to Intel's Conroe desktop processor. Reverse HyperThreading, or Anti-HT technology is, reportedly, a function that would allow multiple CPU cores appear to the OS as a single logical processor.

It is said to boost the performance of single-threaded applications on multi-core processors.

Ever since Intel declared the Conroe, the Internet has been full of speculation about how it will stack up, since AMD's AM2 chips "already have Reverse HT," and "just require" a BIOS update and a new CPU driver. Tech forums on the Net are busy dissecting the issue, though AMD has not made any official comments.

**Buzzword**  
of the MONTH